

Company: IDFC First Bank

Job Profile: Application Engineer

Offer Type: Internship + Placement

Internship Stipend: Not mentioned

CTC: 18.10 LPA (Fixed: 14 LPA + Joining Bonus: 2 L + Variable: 2.10 LPA)

Location: Mumbai/Bangalore/Hyderabad

Process Date: PPT - Jul 25, 2025 (Online)

OA - Jul 28, 2025

Interviews - Jul 30, 2025

Before You Start Reading:

If, while going through this, you feel like “*yaar mujhe toh yeh bhi nahi aata*” - relax! Even I felt the same when I read others' experiences. But trust me, **keep practicing** and things will start clicking. During the interview, it's more about your approach, calmness, and clarity, not just mugged-up answers.

So don't stress **you've got this!**

Quick note: Experience mera hai, lekin shabd GPT ke hain :)

Placement Process:

1. Online Assessment

The OA had 3 sections

- Aptitude (20 mins)
- Computer Fundamentals (30 mins)
- Coding (40 mins)

Coding questions were super direct and easy:

Q1: Find numbers between X and Y whose sum of digits is equal to the highest digit of the number.

(E.g., 100: $1+0+0 = 1$, and highest digit is also 1)

Q2: Return the count of elements whose position changed after sorting and whose position remained same.

(E.g., $2\ 1\ 3\ 4 \rightarrow 1\ 2\ 3\ 4 \rightarrow \text{Count} = 2, 2$)

2. Technical Interview 1 [41 candidates were selected]

Started with a quick intro exchange. The interviewer was chill and said he'll go through my resume while I solve a DSA question.

Before starting, he asked what data structures I'm familiar with. I mentioned **stacks, queues, linked lists, graphs, hashmaps, and priority queues**. I didn't mention trees on purpose, since I wasn't confident and didn't want a question from that topic.

Q1: LRU Cache (just the logic was enough)

Q2: Reverse Linked List (this had to be coded live)

I clarified doubts and kept explaining my thought process. If you're stuck, **talk it out**, they guide you. (For the LRU question, I initially started with a solution that was quite far from the correct approach. The interviewer noticed this and helped guide me a bit. He then asked me to take some time to think it through. After that, I was able to figure out the correct and optimal solution.)

Then we moved on to resume and project discussions.

He gave me a solid tip:

“If you're giving results (Eg. reduced response time by 80%) in your projects, make sure they're real and not simulated.”

Next came:

- Straightforward **OOPs pillars**
- REST API basics (since it was in my resume)
- Asked what is **idempotency** — I blanked out and said so. He was chill about it.
- **PUT vs PATCH** — discussed that too.

Wrapped up with me asking about **automation in banking**.

Tip: Stay calm even if you miss something. Don't panic. Just be honest and smile through it.

3. **Technical Interview 2** [22 candidates were selected]

Again, a friendly start. This time two interviewers were there.

I was asked about my strongest skills. I said **DBMS, SQL, and Java**.

He first asked the port numbers of MySQL and PostgreSQL, which I didn't know.

Then:

- **Sharding, partitioning, and database optimization.**
- Write an SQL to count students with the same name grouped by year.
- A Java function to put(key, value) and get(key), twist was that **value can be any type** (int, string, etc. in the same map). You are allowed to use HashMap.

I tried many ways but couldn't crack that multi-type value part.

They were cross-questioning a lot — not to grill, but to test confidence. **Stick to your answer unless you're really wrong.**

They also asked:

- About my projects
- How form data is stored in a DB the process flows.
- Something on database indexes and **B-tree** (I didn't know and said so)
- Asked about **JWT tokens** in depth.

The interview ended with me asking a question:

“How do you decide which new tech or feature to adopt?”

This round was more of a stress test not to check if you know everything, but to see how you stay calm under pressure, explain your thoughts clearly, and stick to your answers with confidence. They also wanted to see if you communicate clearly and can admit honestly when you don't know something, without losing confidence.

4. **HR round** [9 candidates were selected]

This round felt more like a **friendly chat** than an interview. The HR was very calm and welcoming.

She started with simple questions like:

- “How was your day?”
- “Where do you stay?”
- “Tell me something not in your resume.”
- “Apart from salary, what do you look for in a company?”

Then came some **situational questions**, like:

- “What would you do if ICICI gave you a job offer with the same pay?”
- “What if your teammate is not cooperating on a project?”
- “What would you do if your manager calls you out during a team meeting?”
- “What quality in a person irritates you the most?”
- “What if your manager has those traits that irritate you?”
- “How do you handle conflict or disagreement in a team?”

Tips:

Keep your answers honest but aligned with **company values**. Also, prepare a few things that aren't in your resume — hobbies, side projects, values, or personal traits. If you've made something that your family or friends actually use, make sure to mention it no matter how small . That usually gets them really interested.

5. **Business Round** (Not what it sounds like) [9 candidates were selected]

This was taken by a **Senior Executive** from **IDFC**, and was **completely online**. Honestly, it was more of a casual conversation.

We started by introducing ourselves. He saw **aviation** as one of my hobbies, and we ended up talking about that quite a bit (which was fun ✈).

He then asked me about:

- My projects
- Some basic questions on what I worked on

That was it - **very short and sweet (~15 mins)**.

We wrapped up with me asking him about **banking automation** again.

The results were out the next day, and 8 candidates were selected.

Useful Tips:

Be **curious and genuine**. If you don't know something, say it confidently.

Clarify doubts before jumping into answers, they appreciate it.

Practice **DSA, OOPs, DBMS**, and be ready for **project deep-dives**.

Some of my friends were also asked about **OS** and **CCN**, so it really depends on the panel.

Stay **calm and positive**, even if something goes wrong.

Lastly, enjoy the conversation, they're people too.

Try not to repeat the mistakes I made:

- **Go for an internship**, even if it's unpaid, the experience really helps.
- **Explore different technologies in depth**, not just at the surface level.
- Make sure you have a **strong understanding of everything on your resume** every single detail.

Resources I used:

DSA - [Striver](#) (If not all atleast do the imp ones)

OOPS - [GFG](#)

DBMS - [Notes](#) or [YouTube](#)

SQL - [YouTube](#)

🏆 Honorable mentions : [ChatGPT](#) and [Grok](#)

Contact: [LinkedIn](#) or [WhatsApp](#) (I prefer WhatsApp)

My Resume:  [IDfc_2022600035_Anurag \(2\).pdf](#)

If you've read this far all the best, truly! Interviews can feel scary, but they're just conversations. Stay confident, be genuine, and give your best.